

type scenes and heroic formulas; and the poem is clearly related (in one way or another) to *Beowulf*. To study one aspect of the poem is not necessarily to deny or to denigrate some other aspect of the poem.

If Boenig's account of the history of criticism of the poem is significantly flawed, his discussion of the poem in the context of the (ecclesiastical) history of the early Middle Ages is even more problematical. The first problem Boenig raises, but one that he essentially ignores, is that the *Andreas* legend originated in the late patristic period and was originally a Greco-Christian response to (among other things) the claim of Petrine (Roman) supremacy. Thus the original *Andreas* legend was composed centuries before either penitential theory and practice, the eucharistic debate between Ratramnus and Paschasius Radbertus, or Anselm's rethinking of the dogma of the atonement became important issues for theologians. The issues of eucharistic and atonement theory could not have been current in Anglo-Saxon England until the very late Anglo-Saxon period, and it is no easier to date and localize *Andreas* than it is *Beowulf*. Thus Boenig's attempt to "historicize" *Andreas* is dependent upon a late and necessarily speculative dating of the poem.

The problem of dating and localizing the poem would matter less if Boenig's arguments could be strongly supported from the text of the poem, but penance, eucharistic speculation, and atonement theology do not seem to have been important concerns of the poet. To cite one example of Boenig's argumentation, he suggests that the emphasis on the literal cannibalism of the Mermedonians reflects the poet's support for transubstantiation and the real physical presence of the body and blood of Christ in the eucharistic sacrifice—a position associated with the teaching of Paschasius Radbertus. The cannibalistic feast of the Mermedonians, however, is not a eucharistic feast but a ghastly parody of one, a literal, carnal version of the Eucharist that is intended to disgust and offend. Again Boenig's account of this controversy is misleading in that it was not until very late in or after the Anglo-Saxon period that the differing views of Ratramnus and Paschasius Radbertus became the occasion of ecclesiastical controversy. In the early-medieval period both treatises were associated as (presumably) interesting and complementary views of a difficult issue. Certainly Ælfric, who drew on both of these authors in one homily on the Eucharist, seems to have read them in this way. Again the only detail in the poem that would suggest that the poet might be concerned with penitential theory and practice is the fact that *Andreas*'s momentary disobedience to Christ in the opening of the poem is characterized as sinful in *Andreas*, but not in the (ultimate) Greek source.

This has been a harsher review than I would have liked to have written. In both points of detail and in terms of his larger argument Boenig's discussion of *Andreas* is flawed and inaccurate. But to his credit it must be noted that this is a radically innovative book. Boenig's discussion of the poem is different from that of those critics who have written on the Christian Latin sources and background of the poem. While they have been concerned with explicating the poem passage by passage or in terms of the typological implications of some portion of the narrative, Boenig is concerned with the poem as a whole and with situating it in the context of the intellectual and ecclesiological history of Western Europe in the first millennium. Those are bold aims; and if Boenig fails to accomplish all that he set out to do, we can nonetheless applaud his ambition.

THOMAS D. HILL, Cornell University

JACQUES BERLIOZ and MARIE ANNE POLO DE BEAULIEU, eds., *Les "exempla" médiévaux: Introduction à la recherche, suivie des tables critiques de l'"Index exemplorum" de Frederic C. Tubach*. (Classiques de la Littérature Orale.) Carcassonne: Garac/Hesiodé, 1992. Paper. Pp. 293; 24 black-and-white illustrations. F 195.

FRANZ JOSEF WORSTBROCK, MONIKA KLAES, and JUTTA LÜTTEN, *Repertorium der Artes dic-tandi des Mittelalters*, 1: *Von den Anfängen bis um 1200*. (Münstersche Mittelalter-Schriften, 66.) Munich: Wilhelm Fink, 1992. Pp. xxiv, 183. \$98.

Formal treatises that advise preachers on how to build their sermons have shared in the recent renewed interest in medieval preaching and in formal rhetoric in general. Yet these *artes praedicandi* are notoriously difficult to grasp: few are available in modern editions, fewer still in translation, and their terms are part of a Scholastic vocabulary that relies on technicalities of logic, rhetoric, and occasionally even metaphysics that are utterly foreign to the modern student. There is, then, a great need to supply medievalists with reliable and clear guidance in this field. I doubt that Dr. Briscoe has achieved this in her contribution to the Typologie fascicle under review. Though much indebted to the major studies by Th.-M. Charland and J. J. Murphy (which will remain essential guides), she follows her own way in placing a proportionately greater emphasis on Alan of Lille and, against Murphy, neglecting Thomas of Chobham and Alexander of Ashby (who is not even mentioned). But her account is unfortunately not prepared with the care one desires in a scholarly tool. Besides misprints in Latin quotations, names, and journal titles, confusion of adjectives and of names, misleading statements, and other features of slipshod writing and editing, her account is likely to lead readers seriously astray on matters that are essential to these *artes*. For instance, in pointing out the importance of Alan of Lille for the development of the genre, Briscoe overlooks the ubiquitous use Alan made of distinctions in his model sermons or sermon material; in that respect alone, his treatment approaches more than halfway the full-fledged "Scholastic" sermon structure, whose main characteristics are the *thema* and its division. Further, in Scholastic sermons the *thema* is, against the older homily form, shortened, not as Briscoe claims to just "a complete phrase or sentence" (p. 54), but often to a single word. Some *artes* do indeed recommend a prayer immediately after quoting the theme, but it is much more important to realize that they demand one at the end of the *prothema*, as Briscoe fails to note (pp. 54–55)—a very important structural feature that can help manuscript students distinguish between *prothemata* and complete sermons. Briscoe similarly misrepresents what the fuller *artes* say about the end of the sermon: contrary to her statement that Basevorn and Waleys "simply advise that a fitting prayer be offered" (p. 58), the former, for instance, not only gives precise instructions and examples for the final *unitio* of the developed sermon parts but discusses further aspects of *clausio* (pp. 306–10 in Charland's edition). In this and similar respects Briscoe's repeated question whether the prescriptions of the *artes* were followed in actual sermons can be answered in the affirmative (see, for example, chapter 3 of my own *Preachers, Poets, and the Early English Lyric* [Princeton, 1986]). And her claims that "the final division of most sermon texts from this period seems hardly expanded at all" (p. 57) and that "so few sermons have prothemes" (p. 66) do not agree with the wealth of evidence found in the extant sermon manuscripts.

Briscoe's bibliography is of necessity limited since many studies of medieval preaching touch on *artes praedicandi* but do so only coincidentally. However, students of the subject should know of Jenny Swanson's book on John of Wales (1989); of David d'Avray's examination of the rhyming dictionary by Geraldus de Piscario, in *Franciscan Studies* 38 (1978); and, most importantly, of the edition and translation of Richard of Thetford's treatise "On the Eight Modes of Dilatation" published by George J. Engelhardt in *Al-*

legorica 3 (1978), 77–160. To Briscoe's somewhat confusing listing of modern editions (pp. 68–71) should be added, besides the just-mentioned edition by Engelhardt, that Caplan's number 1 was edited by Servus of Sint Anthonis [Gieben] in *Collectanea Franciscana* 32 (1962), 310–24; that the *Ars praedicandi* by Jacobus de Fusignano exists in early printed editions (see Susan Gallick, in *Mediaeval Studies* 39 [1977], 484); and that the *Summa theologica* of Antoninus of Florence, which contains three and a half chapters dealing with the art of preaching, is easily available in a modern reprint (Graz, 1959).

Following the same pattern of giving a bibliography and then discussing the definition of the genre, its evolution, critical evaluation, influence, editions of relevant medieval texts, and historical value, Barbara H. Jaye, in the same fascicle (pp. 77–118), deals with an "under-examined genre" for which she here offers some "initial spadework" (p. 110). She defines an *ars orandi* as "a work teaching a rhetoric of prayer." The crucial term of her definition is "rhetoric" since texts that teach what prayer is and what inner and external attitudes should accompany it are of course ubiquitous in medieval devotional and pastoral literature and impossible to separate from such larger topics and concerns as monastic rules or penance. To what extent such a literary genre was recognized by medieval authors, what its relation to more general treatments of prayer were, and what rhetorical features of prayer may lie hidden in the large number of still unexplored commentaries on the Pater Noster are all questions that call for much further study.

An important aspect of medieval preaching is the use of exempla, which also furnish raw material for a wide range of other disciplines from folklore to narratology. Their investigation has, during the last generation, generated a large bibliography, yet we desperately need a comprehensive and reliable inventory since the *Index exemplorum* prepared by Tubach in 1969, handy though it is for a first check, has rightly elicited serious criticisms of many kinds. In *Les "exempla" médiévaux* Jacques Berlioz and a team of collaborators provide a "Tubach in reverse," that is, lists of the exempla found in sixteen medieval collections with references to their respective numbers in Tubach where those exempla are briefly described. The medieval collections range from Petrus Alfonsi's *Disciplina clericalis* to Pauli's *Schimpf und Ernst* and are all available in modern editions. The indexing is critical and notes many errors in Tubach, from typographical slips to important omissions. These tables are preceded by a bibliographical introduction (pp. 17–73), in which Berlioz, as it were, gives a spirited introductory lecture to a graduate seminar on medieval exempla that is structured around the question, "How do you identify an exemplum, especially if it is not in Tubach?" All this is very helpful, and one wishes Berlioz and his team the best of speed to accomplish what is desperately needed at this point: the creation of an authoritative template that can be used by scholars anywhere to analyze and inventory exempla in a consistent and universally accepted format, so that this fascinating and enormously rich material can then be entered directly into an electronic database.

Another team of scholars, this one at Münster, presents the first of a series of volumes aimed at furnishing, in chronological order, a complete descriptive inventory of medieval *artes dictandi*. This volume covers the period from about 1080 (Alberic of Montecassino) to about 1200 (just before Boncompagno and other masters from Bologna) and thereby sets the pattern of a periodization that reflects important developments in the history of the genre. The book includes twenty-one authors, twenty-four anonymous *artes*, and two anonymous fragments. Each entry discusses the contents and peculiar features of the respective work, as well as its date, author, redactions, and transmission, and lists all known manuscripts. All this is accompanied with full bibliographical references, thus creating a comprehensive and reliable foundation for the history and further explorations of the genre, and presented in a well-thought-out format and crisp style that are exemplary.